The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Eight Maṇḍalas

Āryāṣṭamaṇḍalakanāmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 882 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་དཀྱིལ་འཁོར་བརྒྱད་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་ཐེག་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མདོ།

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Eight Maṇḍalas, known in Sanskrit as Ārya Aṣṭamaṇḍalaka nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra and in Tibetan as Pakpa Kyilkhor Gyepa, is a short Mahāyāna sūtra set on Mount Potalaka, the abode of the noble bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara. There, amid a vast assembly of bodhisattvas, the bodhisattva Jewel Essence Moonlight rises respectfully and asks the Blessed One for permission to pose a question. This request opens a teaching centered on a set of eight maṇḍalas, which are associated with devotional and ritual practice and its benefits. The work is Toh 882 in the Kangyur, where it is placed among texts of a ritual and dhāraṇī character, and a closely related version of the same sūtra also appears elsewhere in the collection.

In the language of India: ārya aṣṭamaṇḍalka nāma mahāyāna sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Eight Maṇḍalas.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling on Mount Potalaka, in the abode of the noble Avalokiteśvara, together with many hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of bodhisattvas. Among that very assembly of bodhisattvas was the bodhisattva great being called Jewel Essence Moonlight, who had gathered there and was seated. He rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and placed his right knee on the ground. Bowing toward the Blessed One with his palms joined, he addressed the Blessed One with these words: "If the Blessed One will grant me the opportunity to put my questions and have them answered, I would ask the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, about a certain matter."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva great being Jewel Essence Moonlight: "Jewel Essence Moonlight, ask whatever you wish, and I shall delight your mind by answering each and every question you ask."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva great being Jewel Essence Moonlight addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed

One, if any son or daughter of noble family wishes to perform the eight maṇḍalas, how should they perform them?"

The Blessed One declared: "Son of noble family, it is good that you have found the confidence to ask this, for the great benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, and in order to accomplish the incomparable wisdom of the beings born in the three times. Excellent, excellent! Therefore, son of noble family, listen to the heart mantras of the eight bodhisattvas, by the mere recitation of which the five acts of immediate retribution are purified and all accomplishments are attained.

oṃ mahā hūṃ mahā vīra svāhā. With this heart mantra one makes offering to the Blessed One at the center.

oṃ hrī hūṃ padma priya svāhā. This is the heart mantra of the noble Avalokiteśvara.

oṃ mai hā rā ṇa svāhā. This is the heart mantra of Maitreya.

oṃ ā kā śa garbhā ya svāhā. This is the heart mantra of Ākāśagarbha.

oṃ svā hri rā ja ya svāhā. This is the heart mantra of Samantabhadra.

oṃ ku ru bha na ra ha svāhā. This is the heart mantra of Vajrapāṇi.

oṃ śrī aṃ raṃ ga svāhā. This is the heart mantra of the youthful Mañjuśrī.

oṃ ni svā raṃ bha svāhā. This is the heart mantra of Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin.

oṃ kṣi ti ha rā ja svāhā. This is the heart mantra of Kṣitigarbha.

If any son or daughter of noble family recites these heart mantras of the eight bodhisattvas, together with that of the Tathāgata, even once before the maṇḍala, all their aims will be accomplished, and they will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those bodhisattva great beings rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Eight Maṇḍalas.

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor and translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and it was further revised in accordance with the new terminology and finalized.

Translator's Notes

• The name of the questioning bodhisattva, Tibetan "Rinchen Nyingpo Dawa Nangwa," could not be securely matched to an attested Sanskrit form (perhaps something like Ratnagarbhacandraprabha). It has therefore been rendered by its meaning as "Jewel Essence Moonlight." The "five acts of immediate retribution" (ānantarya) are the five heinous deeds whose karmic result ripens immediately after death.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.